

EDGE SERIES

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2020

The edges—another powerful metaphor of bodily contact between different realities— of the canvas were the principal compositional element (this also incidentally means these paintings are impossible to photograph). Fluctuations between figure and ground and between the figurative and the abstract were important ‘edges’, resistances to easy readability.

Heightened impasto, use of differently produced textures, velocities, scars, marks at different physical scales, were important in creating a body that I wanted viewers to move towards and away and around.

Though one visual language, of peripheral figure and central ground, governs the series, each painting is a variation, an experiment. The source of the experiment was sometimes a reaction to a philosophy of the body (Agamben’s biopolitics), sometimes a formal or technical problem, sometimes the variety inherent in the metaphor of painting as body.

The encounters are shaped as well: most are for mounting near the ground on specially created stands, one is meant to be viewed mounted parallel to the floor, one is a light installation.



How would you tell a story from the margins?

Oil on canvas - 48" x 72" 2020



This was the first of the large canvases to be made. The intent here was to keep the 'peripheral figure' visual language and yet create a sense of narrative.

How would you tell a story from the margins?

Detail



Is erotic attraction reducible to physics?

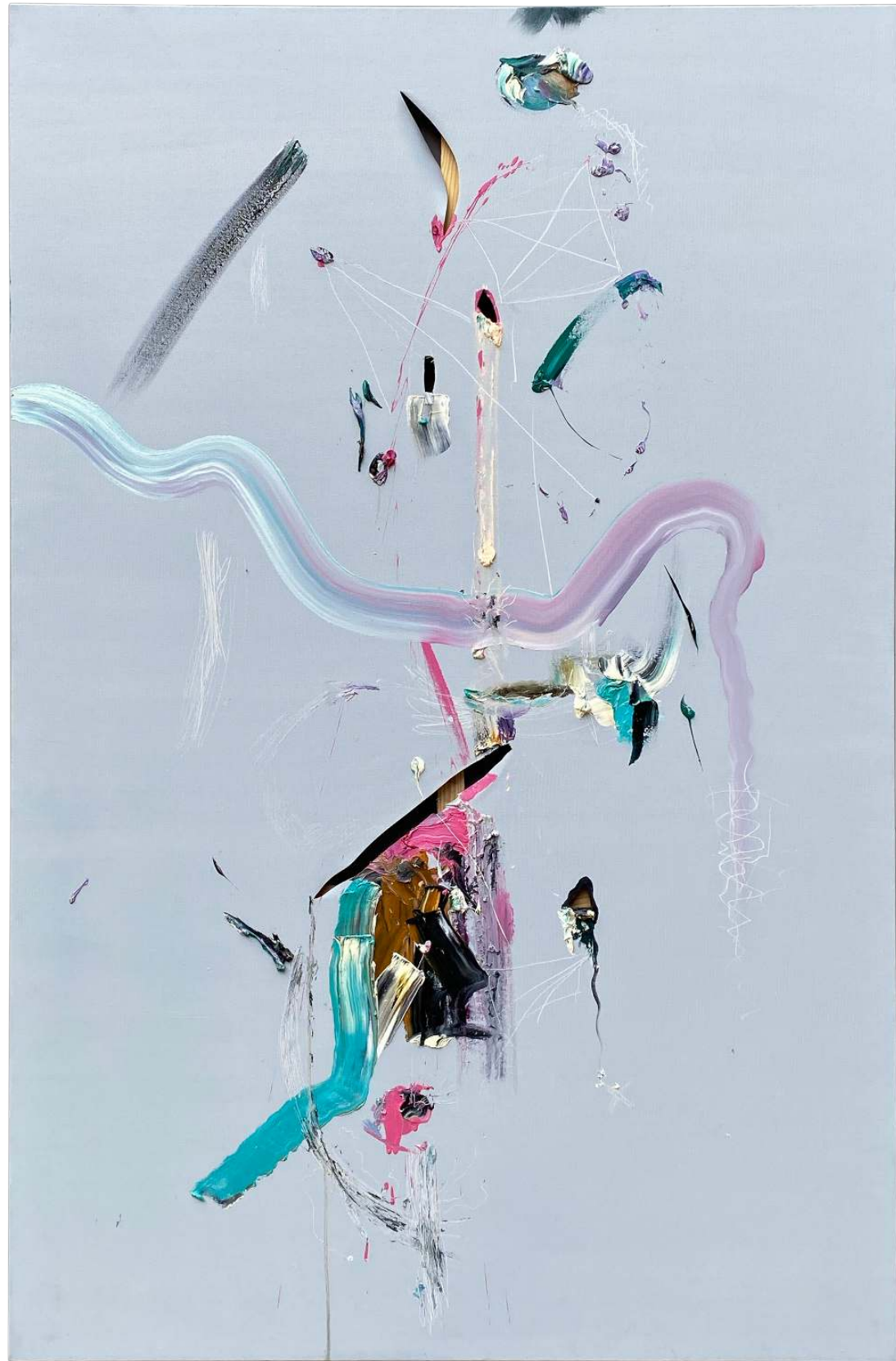
Oil on canvas - 72" x 48" 2020



Here the goal was the recapture the strange sensation of physical attraction to another person, how it lives between the edges of the material and spiritual.

Is erotic attraction reducible to physics?

Detail



If my body were opened up, what would you see?

Oil on canvas - 72" x 48" 2020



This was a more adventurous exploration of the connections between the metaphors of edge, frame and body. The frame holding up the canvas is exposed and painted; there are wounds, scars, tears, all attempts at displaying the mortal frame to a voyeuristic knowledge.

If my body were opened up, what would you see?

Detail



What kind of body do you possess in a dream?

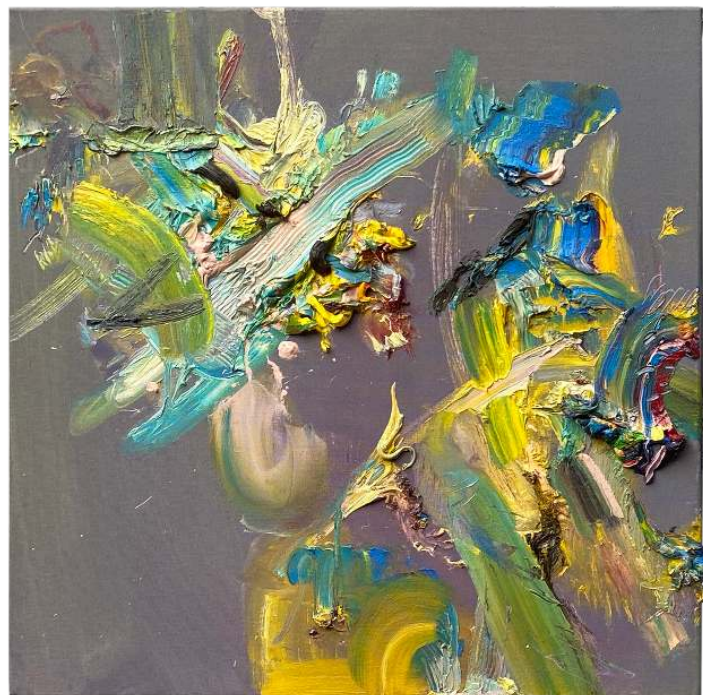
Oil on canvas - 72" x 48" 2020



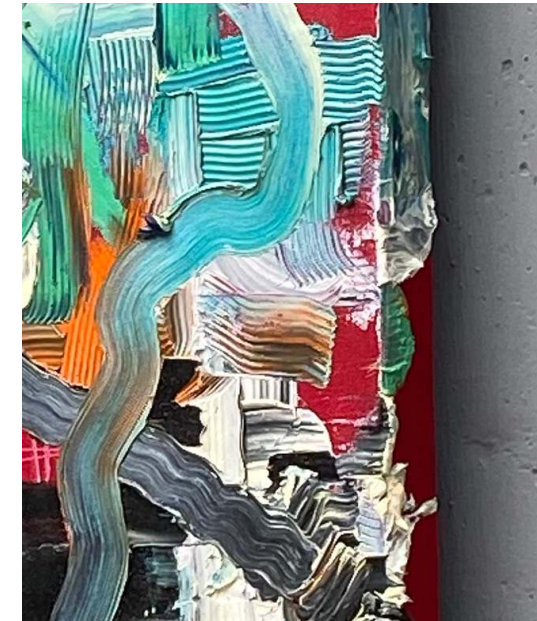
This is a light installation lasting 40 minutes, with slowly varying luminosity. The painting was executed under an altered state of consciousness. The intent thus was phenomenological: what difference does the artist's consciousness make if any to the artwork?

What kind of body do you possess in a dream?

Detail



The intent was to try and translate the genre of diptych into the formal resemblance between bodies, by avoiding usual principles of diptychs such as near exact repetition, stark color contrasts etc.



This diptych is based on thematic contrast. One of the canvases tries to represent a bureaucratized form of life reduced to ID numbers, and the other a more anarchic 'creative' life.



Can a landscape be miniaturized?

Oil on canvas - 12" x 16" 2020



The problem here was technical. How much of the language developed in the series could be preserved at a very different scale. What happens to the various kind of marks developed for the series when miniaturized?

Can a landscape be miniaturized?

Detail



Is a dead body a body or a thing?

Oil on canvas - 72" x 48" 2020



This is meant to be mounted parallel to the ground, as in a morgue or autopsy. The formal restriction was to explore the visual language in monochrome, while evoking a sense of the art history of dissection bodies.

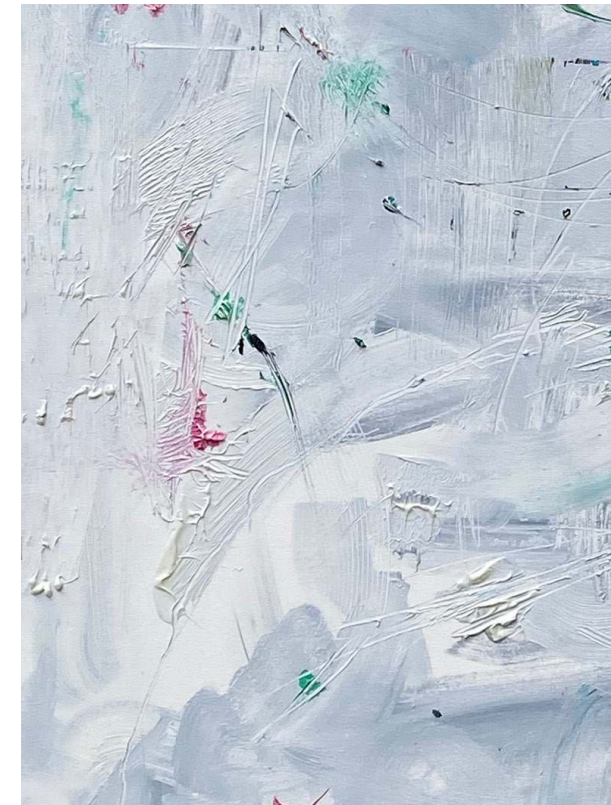
Is a dead body a body or a thing?

Detail



The presence of the beloved's absence.

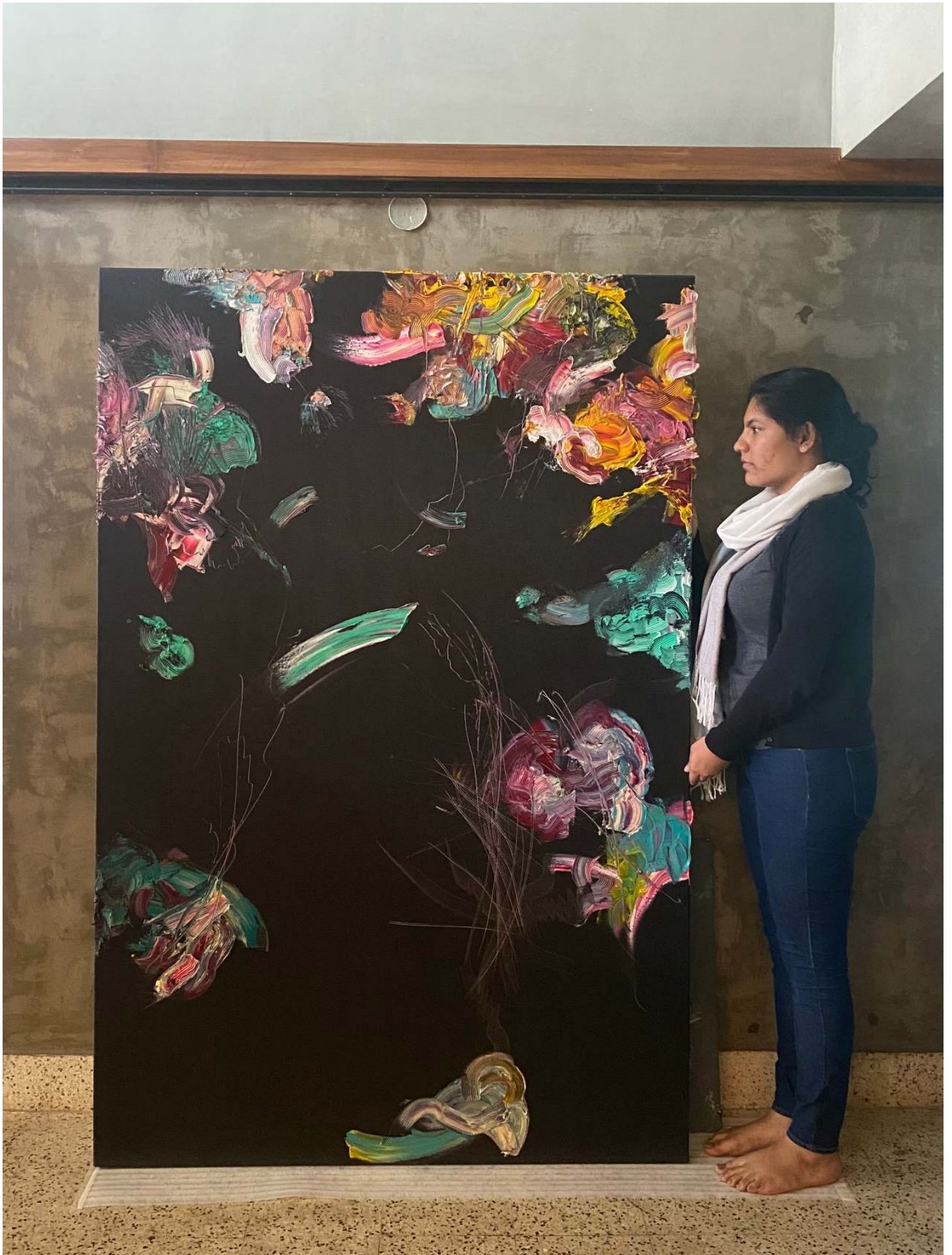
Oil on canvas - 72" x 48" , 24" X 18" 2020



A small canvas was painted in the edge visual style (the 'stamp') and its touch on the larger blank canvas was used, in conjunction with purely negative marks (scrapes, scratches, removals of paint) to create the larger composition. The idea was to have the 'memory' or 'record' of a painting be a painting in itself, like how a dead loved one's things retain her presence.

The presence of the beloved's absence.

Detail



scale reference of a 48" X 72" work